

DNS Walkthrough : Raaeel Fatima Portfolio

Website: <https://raaeel-portfolio.vercel.app/>

DNS (Domain Name System) is what connects a human-readable website address to the server that hosts the website. For example, instead of remembering an IP address, a user can type a domain such as `raaeel-portfolio.vercel.app`.

What is a CNAME record?

A **CNAME (Canonical Name) record** is a DNS record that makes one domain name an alias for another hostname. It is commonly used when a custom domain or subdomain needs to point to a service that is hosting the website.

For my future FlyRank subdomain, for example:

`raaeelfatima.flyrank.ai`

the DNS record will be configured by FlyRank Ops to point the subdomain toward the appropriate hosting target. I will then add the FlyRank domain in my hosting provider's domain settings. The exact CNAME value will depend on the hosting configuration provided at that time.

What happens when someone visits the website?

When a user types my website address into a browser, the browser first needs to find where that domain is hosted.

1. The browser asks a **DNS resolver** to find the address associated with the domain.
2. If the resolver does not already have the answer cached, it communicates with the relevant **DNS nameservers**.
3. The nameserver returns the DNS record for the requested domain.
4. The resolver sends the result back to the user's browser.
5. The browser uses that information to connect to the hosting service where my website is deployed.
6. The hosting service responds with the website files, and the browser displays the page.

DNS information can take some time to update after a record is changed. This is called **DNS propagation**, and cached records can cause different users to see the old or new record temporarily.

HTTPS

My current portfolio is already served over **HTTPS** through Vercel. When the site is correctly configured over HTTPS, the browser shows the padlock/security indicator.

When my FlyRank subdomain is provided after my capstone is approved, I will add the custom domain to my hosting settings, make sure the DNS record points correctly, wait for DNS propagation, and confirm that the site loads over HTTPS.

Current status

My portfolio is currently live at:

<https://raaeel-portfolio.vercel.app/>

The FlyRank subdomain does not need to be configured yet because it will be provisioned after the capstone is approved. The website itself will not need to be rebuilt; the custom domain will simply point to the existing hosted site.